SAMPLE POLICY TEMPLATE

AI Acceptable Use Policy

A starting point for setting clear rules on how your people use AI tools at work.

Important: read before using this template

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- **Current as of October 2026.** AI tools, vendor terms and regulation are changing quickly. Check the policy against current requirements at each review.

How to use this template

1. Replace every item in [square brackets] with your own details, and delete any that do not apply.
2. Shaded guidance notes explain choices you need to make. Delete them before the policy is approved.
3. Align the data rules in Section 6 with your existing information classification scheme.
4. Replace the ilene.ai branding with your own, and remove this page, before you publish the final policy.

[Placeholder] replace with your details | **Guidance note** delete before approval

Want help adapting and rolling it out?

Through AI Governance, ilene.ai works with your leadership, legal and privacy advisors to set AI policy, approved tools and oversight that fit how your organization operates.

Book a strategy call

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POLICY

[Organization] AI Acceptable Use Policy

Policy owner	[Role, for example Chief Operating Officer]
Approved by	[Name, title or governing body]
Effective date	[Date]
Next review date	[Date, no later than 12 months after the effective date]
Version	[1.0]
Related policies	[Information security, privacy, records management, code of conduct, acceptable use of technology]

1 Purpose

This policy sets out how people working for or on behalf of [Organization] may use artificial intelligence (AI) tools, including generative AI, in their work. Its aim is to support productive, responsible use of AI while protecting [Organization]'s information, people, clients and reputation.

2 Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, temporary staff, volunteers and [other groups] who use AI tools for [Organization] work, on any device, including personal devices and personal accounts when they are used for work.

It covers:

- standalone generative AI tools, such as chat assistants and image, audio, video or code generators
- AI features built into software [Organization] already uses, such as email, office, meeting, customer relationship management or finance systems
- AI tools that [Organization] builds, configures or customizes

This policy works alongside [Organization]'s related policies listed above. Where requirements differ, the stricter requirement applies.

3 Definitions

Term	Meaning
AI tool	Software that uses machine learning or similar techniques to generate content, make predictions, classify information or recommend actions.
Generative AI	AI tools that create new text, images, audio, video or code in response to a prompt.
Approved AI tool	An AI tool, and the configuration of it, that [Organization] has assessed and listed as approved under Section 5.
Output	Anything an AI tool produces, including text, summaries, images, code, analysis and recommendations.
Personal information	Information about an identifiable individual, as defined in applicable privacy law.

Term	Meaning
Confidential information	Non-public information about [Organization], its clients, partners or people, as defined in [information classification policy].

4 Guiding principles

- **People stay accountable.** The person who uses an AI tool is responsible for the work it helps produce.
- **Protect information.** Only put information into an AI tool when this policy allows it.
- **Verify before relying.** AI output can be wrong, incomplete, outdated or biased. Check it before you use it.
- **Be transparent.** Be open about AI use where people would reasonably expect to know.
- **Treat people fairly.** Do not use AI in ways that could unfairly disadvantage individuals or groups.
- **Use approved tools.** Work information belongs in tools [Organization] has assessed.

5 Approved AI tools

[Organization] maintains a list of approved AI tools at [location, for example the intranet page]. The list states what each tool may be used for and the highest classification of information it may receive.

Approved tool	Approved uses	Highest information permitted	Tool owner
[Tool name and plan]	[For example, drafting, summarizing, analysis]	[For example, Internal]	[Role]
[Tool name and plan]	[Approved uses]	[Classification]	[Role]

To request a new tool or a new use, submit a request to [team or role] describing the business purpose, the information involved and the vendor. Requests are assessed for security, privacy, legal, cost and operational fit before approval.

> **Guidance note:** Before approving a tool, review the vendor's terms on data retention, use of your data to train models, where data is stored and processed, and security certifications. Business or enterprise plans often have different terms from free or personal plans. Confirm the terms that apply to the plan you are buying.

6 Information you may use with AI tools

Use the table below to decide what information may be entered into, uploaded to or connected with an AI tool.

Information classification	Approved AI tools	Unapproved or public AI tools
Public: approved for public release	Permitted	Permitted
Internal: general business information not intended for the public	Permitted	Not permitted
Confidential: sensitive business, client or partner information	Permitted only in tools approved for confidential information	Not permitted

Information classification	Approved AI tools	Unapproved or public AI tools
Personal information: about clients, employees or others	Permitted only in tools approved for personal information, for a purpose covered by a completed privacy review	Not permitted
Restricted: [for example, legal privilege, security credentials, health or financial account information]	Not permitted unless approved in writing by [role]	Not permitted

If you are unsure how information is classified, treat it as Confidential and ask [contact].

> **Guidance note:** Replace these categories with your own classification scheme. Privacy legislation may set specific rules for personal information, including consent, purpose, retention and where information may be stored or accessed. Public bodies may have additional obligations under privacy, information access and records legislation. Confirm the rules that apply to you with counsel.

7 Acceptable uses

Subject to Sections 5 and 6, AI tools may be used to:

- draft, edit and improve the clarity of documents, emails and presentations
- summarize documents and meetings the user is entitled to access
- generate ideas, outlines and options for discussion
- find a starting point for research, with sources checked independently
- write, review and explain code, with review before it is deployed
- analyze data the user is permitted to use in that tool
- translate content for internal understanding, with review before any external use
- [other uses specific to your organization]

8 Prohibited uses

AI tools must not be used to:

- enter, upload or connect information above the classification permitted in Section 6
- make, or materially influence, decisions about individuals, such as hiring, discipline, pay, eligibility, credit or access to services, unless the use has been specifically approved, assessed and includes meaningful human review
- create content that is discriminatory, harassing, defamatory, deceptive or unlawful
- impersonate a real person, or create synthetic images, audio or video of a real person without their consent and approval from [role]
- present output as verified fact, professional advice or original work without the review required in Section 9
- bypass security controls, tool safeguards or this policy
- monitor or evaluate employees, except as authorized under [policy]
- enter content that [Organization] does not have the right to use in that way, such as material under confidentiality or licence restrictions
- [other prohibited uses specific to your organization]

9 Human review and accountability

The person using an AI tool is responsible for the accuracy and appropriateness of anything produced with it. Before relying on or sharing output, review it for:

- factual errors, invented facts, references or citations
- outdated information
- bias, unfair assumptions or inappropriate language
- confidential or personal information that should not be included
- consistency with [Organization]'s policies, standards and tone

Higher-impact uses, including content for clients, regulators, the public or legal and financial matters, require review by [role or a qualified person] before release. An AI tool cannot be recorded as the author, reviewer or approver of any [Organization] decision or document.

10 Transparency and disclosure

- Disclose AI use in external content when [Organization] requires it or when a reasonable reader would expect to know.
- When an AI system interacts directly with clients or the public on [Organization]'s behalf, make clear that they are dealing with an AI system and offer a route to a person.
- Label AI-generated or materially AI-altered images, audio and video when they are shared outside [Organization].

> **Guidance note:** Decide your disclosure threshold, for example any externally published content where AI generated a substantial part. Some jurisdictions, sectors and publishers set their own disclosure requirements.

11 Intellectual property and third-party rights

- AI output may resemble existing protected works and may not be protected by copyright in the way human-created work is. Check significant external content before publication.
- Respect the licence and usage terms of each AI tool.
- Ownership of work created with AI tools for [Organization] is governed by [employment agreements, contractor agreements or intellectual property policy].

12 Security

- Use [Organization] accounts and single sign-on for approved tools where available. Do not share credentials.
- Apply the privacy and data settings required for each approved tool, such as turning off chat history or model training where [Organization] requires it.
- Do not connect AI tools to [Organization] systems, files or mailboxes unless the connection is approved.
- Be alert to AI-enabled phishing, voice cloning and deepfakes. Verify unusual requests for payments, credentials or information through a known, separate channel.

13 Reporting incidents and concerns

Report the following to [contact or channel] as soon as possible:

- information entered into an AI tool that this policy does not permit
- output that has caused, or could cause, harm, a complaint or a material error
- an AI tool behaving unexpectedly or outside its approved use

- suspected fraud, impersonation or security incidents involving AI

Report in good faith. [Organization] does not tolerate retaliation against anyone who raises a concern under this policy.

14 Roles and responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Policy owner: [role]	Maintains this policy, approves exceptions and reports on AI use to [leadership or board].
[Information technology and security]	Assesses tools, manages the approved tool list and configures security settings.
[Privacy officer]	Completes privacy reviews and advises on personal information.
[Legal]	Reviews vendor terms, intellectual property and regulatory obligations.
People leaders	Make sure their teams know this policy, complete training and use AI within approved uses.
Everyone in scope	Follows this policy, completes training, reviews output and reports incidents.

15 Training

Everyone in scope must complete [Organization]'s AI awareness training before using approved AI tools for work, and [annually] after that. Additional training may be required for specific tools or higher-impact uses.

16 Exceptions

Requests for an exception must be made in writing to the policy owner, with the business reason, the information involved and the controls proposed. Approved exceptions are documented, time-limited and reviewed before they are renewed.

17 Compliance

Breaches of this policy are handled under [disciplinary policy, contractor agreements or applicable collective agreements]. [Organization] may suspend access to AI tools while a concern is reviewed.

> **Guidance note:** Make sure the consequences described here are consistent with your existing employment policies, contracts and any collective agreements.

18 Review

This policy is reviewed at least every [12 months], and sooner if there is a significant change in applicable law, the AI tools in use or the way [Organization] uses AI.

Appendix A: Rollout checklist

- [ ] A policy owner is named and accountable.
- [ ] Current AI use across teams is mapped, including tools staff already use.
- [ ] Data rules are aligned with your information classification scheme.
- [ ] Legal, privacy and security reviews of the adapted policy are complete.
- [ ] The approved tool list is published, with uses and data limits for each tool.
- [ ] Related policies are cross-referenced and any conflicts are resolved.
- [ ] The policy is communicated, with practical examples for each team.
- [ ] Training is available and completion is tracked.
- [ ] Acknowledgments are collected, if you use Appendix B.
- [ ] The incident reporting route is tested.
- [ ] The first review date is set.

Appendix B: Acknowledgment (optional)

I confirm that I have read and understood the [Organization] AI Acceptable Use Policy, version [x.x], and that I will follow it. I understand that I am responsible for work I produce with AI tools, and that I should ask [contact] if I am unsure how the policy applies.

Name _____ Role or team _____

Signature _____ Date _____